BREMERTON SPORTS CENTER

LEAGUE FIELD & RULE BOOK

Facility Rules, Adult & Youth Indoor Soccer Leagues

Document	Version	Effective Date	Next Review
League Rule Book	1.0	November 2026	As Needed
Prepared By	BSC Management	**Reviewed By**	General Manager

QUESTIONS & CONTACTS

- Rules questions or concerns: ref@BremertonSports.com
- Facility, account, and forfeit notices: Info@BremertonSports.com or Guest Services
- These rules take precedence over the US Indoor Sports Association "Official Rules of Indoor Soccer" wherever the two conflict.

TABLE OF CONTENTS

1. FACILITY RULES **3**
2. ALL SOCCER LEAGUES RULES **4**
2.1 RELEGATION SYSTEM 4
2.2 THE PLAYERS 4
2.3 GUEST PLAYERS (SUBS) 4
2.4 EQUIPMENT 4
2.5 DURATION OF THE GAME 5
2.6 FORFEITING 5
2.7 FOULS 5
2.8 INJURY SUBSTITUTION 6
2.9 BLUE/RED CARD SYSTEM, SUSPENSIONS AND EJECTIONS 6
2.10 FREE KICKS 7
2.11 INTIMIDATION RULE 7
2.12 MERCY RULE 8
2.13 GOALKEEPERS 8
3. YOUTH LEAGUES RULES **9**
3.1 THE PLAYERS 9
3.2 THE BALL 9
3.3 THE COACHES 9
3.4 SAFETY 9
3.5 MERCY RULE 9
3.6 FIELD 3 RULES 10

1. FACILITY RULES

We pride ourselves in providing a safe and dry environment where friends and families from our community can get together and have a good time participating in recreational events at a reasonable cost. Our fields are completely enclosed. As such, it is required that our guests adhere to the following basic safety rules as a minimum:

- **NO** outdoor cleats are allowed on the fields.
- **NO** food, drinks, or chewing gum are allowed on the fields.
- **ABSOLUTELY NO** sliding is allowed on the fields.
- **NO** spitting on the fields (WE WILL EJECT YOU (Red Card) with a minimum 1 MONTH SUSPENSION!)
- Respect each other. This includes guests, players, referees, staff, etc.; **NO FOUL LANGUAGE!**
- For soccer leagues and related events: **SHIN GUARDS ARE REQUIRED!**

Those in violation of the above rules may be asked to leave the facility. Your participation is welcome and appreciated. Should you have any questions or concerns, please don't hesitate to see our Guest Services staff for assistance or email Info@BremertonSports.com.

Referees and BSC staff have the discretion to remove individuals found to be intoxicated or under the influence of substances that impair their ability to participate safely. These individuals will not be allowed to participate in any activities and may be asked to leave the facility. Have fun, keep it safe, and enjoy yourself in the spirit of the game.

2. ALL SOCCER LEAGUES RULES

Wherever there is a conflict, these rules take precedence over the "Official Rules of Indoor Soccer" as published by the US Indoor Sports Association.

Please email ref@BremertonSports.com with any questions or concerns about our rules.

2.1 RELEGATION SYSTEM

The relegation system is designed to ensure the fair distribution of teams across various leagues, tailored to meet the specific needs of each league. At the conclusion of each season, teams that finish at or near the top of their league standings will be promoted to the next higher league for the subsequent season. Conversely, teams that finish at the bottom of their league standings will be relegated to the next lower league. This system is implemented to maintain competitiveness across all leagues and to minimize the occurrence of lopsided matches. The relegation system is widely recognized as the preferred approach for soccer leagues globally.

The specific number of teams promoted and relegated each season is determined by the league's needs and the size of the leagues. Typically, approximately two teams are promoted and relegated from each league per season, although this number may vary.

2.2 THE PLAYERS

- Unless otherwise stated, leagues will play 5v5 plus a keeper for a total of 6 players on the field per team during each game.
- A minimum of 4 total players must be on the field at all times (including keeper).
- Coed leagues are required to have a minimum of 2 female FIELD players on the field at all times. Female players may sub for male players, but the minimum number must be met for a full team fielded. (If a team only has 1 female player on the field, they will have to play shorthanded.)

2.3 GUEST PLAYERS (SUBS)

Process: Subs must obtain a "sub slip" from Guest Services prior to the beginning of the second half of the game that they are subbing in. Fees may apply.

A guest player (sub) is a player who is not rostered on the team they would like to play for but has received permission from the team to play for the team temporarily for a given game. Prior to the sub playing, a sub must obtain a "sub slip" from Guest Services for ***each*** game they plan on playing in (fee(s) may apply). The sub slip for each game must be provided by the sub to the referee of the game they plan on playing in *before* that player steps foot on the field.

A sub slip may only be obtained by a player who does not have an outstanding account balance owed to the facility and whose membership is current and in good standing. A sub slip will not be issued to a player who is currently suspended or not allowed back in the facility (e.g., a player who is serving a Red Card suspension).

2.4 EQUIPMENT

- Shin guards are required for all play. A reminder will be given by the referee prior to the game's start. If a player fails to put them in at this time, the player assumes the risk of injury.
- No dangerous objects may be worn (e.g., hard casts without padding, jewelry, watches, or other objects that could injure).
    - Bracelets, watches, or Fitbits may be worn if covered by a sweatband. (Sweatbands may be purchased at Guest Services.)
- Cleats are not allowed on ANY of our playing surfaces at any time. Turf shoes, tennis shoes, and indoor shoes only.

  - This applies to ALL field play. Anyone wearing cleats in a league game will be removed from the field until proper footwear is put on.
  - Any rental with players wearing cleats will have their rental stopped until all players remove their cleats. Lost time will not be refunded.
  - Any player entering a game in violation of these rules will be called for a foul and the other team will be presented with a free kick.
- Teams are required to have both a dark-colored shirt and a light-colored shirt to distinguish themselves from the opposing team. This requirement applies to all guest players as well.
  - Guest players must wear the correct colors corresponding to the team they are playing for.
  - The shirt colors must be the exact same shade or very similar. For example, if a team's light-colored shirt is bright red, all teammates and guest players must wear a bright red shirt or a similar shade. A maroon-colored shirt would be considered a dark-colored shirt and would not be allowed during the game.
  - If the main colors of the opposing teams are the same, the team designated as the "HOME" team will be required to change to their alternate color.
  - If any player (including guest players) does not have the correct color for the team they are playing with, the default colors will be black for the dark-colored shirted team and white for the light-colored shirted team.
  - Goalkeepers must wear a jersey that is a different color from both their own team and the opposing team. This rule also applies to any player temporarily acting as a goalkeeper, regardless of the duration.

2.5 DURATION OF THE GAME

- For adult leagues, games will consist of two 22-minute and 30-second halves unless otherwise noted (e.g., tournament play).
- For youth leagues, games will consist of two 20-minute halves unless otherwise noted (e.g., tournament play).
- Games **WILL** start at their scheduled time.
- Teams who do not have enough players (4 minimum players needed to play) when the clock starts will have 5 minutes to get another player and not be charged a late fee.
- Unless otherwise noted, games on the small field will consist of two 20-minute halves or four 10-minute quarters.

2.6 FORFEITING

- Teams who desire to forfeit their upcoming game must notify the facility as soon as possible (by calling or emailing Info@BremertonSports.com) so the facility may notify the other team as quickly and early as possible.
- Regardless of when the facility is notified, the team manager on the forfeiting team roster will be fined the ***cost of a game in that session*** to divide amongst their team as they see fit.
- The team that did not forfeit will be credited the ***cost of a game in that session***.
- A game is considered **LATE** and not a **FORFEIT** if a team that didn't have enough players when the clock started gets the minimum required number of players 5 or more minutes from the clock starting.
- A game is considered a **FORFEIT** if a team does not have enough players after 10 minutes have passed from the clock starting. If a game is considered a **FORFEIT**, the referee will then call the game as such, record which team forfeited, then set the clock for the remaining time that the team that was forfeited against can then use if they would still like to play. The referee is not required to be down on the field in this instance but can be requested to stay if the teams would like to split up and play.

2.7 FOULS

- You may not go to the ground with any part of the body in order to play the ball.

- No sliding, no sliding kicks, no sliding blocks, no playing the ball while on the ground.
- If, in the referee's opinion, you cannot play the ball without going to the ground, a foul will be called.
  - "On the ground" is defined as any situation where a player has anything other than their two feet in contact with the ground, such as a knee, hand, or other body part.
  - Any attempt to shoot the ball must end with the player landing on their feet. This includes but is not limited to diving headers, bicycle kicks, etc.
  - This rule applies whether the ball is in play, around the player, or after making a pass or shot. Any attempt to play the ball while on the ground will be considered a foul.
- **ANY SLIDE TACKLE WILL RESULT IN AN AUTOMATIC BLUE CARD!**

2.8 INJURY SUBSTITUTION

- If the referee stops play for a player injury, that player must sub off before play can resume.
  - They may sub back in afterwards.
  - This rule does not apply if the team has no substitutes (or no substitutes of the sex of the injured player in coed leagues).
  - Players must leave the field as quickly and efficiently as possible, depending on the injury.

2.9 BLUE/RED CARD SYSTEM, SUSPENSIONS AND EJECTIONS

Blue Cards

Blue Cards are issued for serious or persistent violations of the rules.

- A two-minute time penalty will be given for Blue Card offenses.
- Goalkeepers must serve their own time penalties.

The following situations will result in a Blue Card being issued.

Severe Blue Cards

1. Boarding
2. Coming Off Bench for Altercation
3. Excessive Fouling
4. Retaliation
5. Slide Tackling
6. Unsporting Behavior

Standard Blue Cards

1. Extra Man
2. Intentional Handball
3. Intimidation
4. Time-Wasting
   - With less than two minutes left in the second half, if the referee calls time-wasting, the referee will issue a Blue Card to the offending player, note the time on the clock when the Blue Card was issued, and add 30 seconds to the clock from that time. The clock will start upon the ball being put back in play.

Situation-Dependent (Referee's Discretion)

1. Goal-Scoring Opportunity
2. Keeper Foul
3. Last Man

Red Cards

The following situations will result in a Red Card being issued. Red Cards are ejections from the game.

1. Any combination of three (3) Blue Cards given to the same player in a single game
2. Two (2) severe Blue Cards given to the same player in a single game
3. Swearing at the referee directly
4. Fighting
5. Violence off the ball or outside of play
6. Slurs and/or discrimination

Suspensions and Ejections

Blue Card Accumulation

Any player that receives three (3) Blue Cards in one calendar month (from the first of the month through the last day of the month) will be suspended a minimum of one week, beginning the day after the player accumulated their third Blue Card in the month.

Red Cards

Any player receiving a Red Card is required to leave the facility immediately. Play does not restart until the carded player leaves the playing field and the player benches. If the player does not leave in a timely fashion, the carded player's team can be given a Blue Card for time-wasting, which in turn will result in the team going down an additional player until the time is served for the Blue Card, or the opposing team scores.

If a Red Card is issued, the offending team must serve a 2-minute time penalty in full regardless of whether or not the other team scores.

Red Cards will be assessed a minimum *mandatory* 2-week suspension from all play at the facility.

All Red Cards will be reviewed by management in a timely manner, and additional fines and/or suspension time may be added at management's discretion.

Fighting and trying to instigate a fight will not be tolerated and will carry heavy suspensions and fines.

2.10 FREE KICKS

- All free kicks on the large fields are direct; all free kicks on the small field are indirect.
- Penalty kicks will be taken at the top of the arch with all other players behind the attacking line. Penalty kicks will be given if a Blue Card foul is committed in the box.
- All other fouls in the box will be a free kick at the top of the arch with a wall allowed.
- All opponents must be 15 feet from the ball on all restarts, marked by the white line in the box.
- On keeper restarts or free kicks in the defensive arch, the opposing team must be 15 feet away from the arch until the ball is in play.
- A player intentionally blocking the keeper from distributing the ball from inside of 15 feet will be issued a Blue Card.

2.11 INTIMIDATION RULE

The intimidation rule is intended to decrease the chances of players getting struck by the ball unnecessarily. This rule applies only to Women's C and all Coed C and D levels. There are three parts to this rule:

Part 1: Was the ball SHOT with force towards another player?

- **Yes:** Continue to Part 2.
- **No:** No intimidation rule violation.

Part 2: Did the ball strike another player in the head?

- **Yes:** Call a foul on the player that struck the ball and issue a Blue Card for a 2-minute penalty.

- **No:** Continue to Part 3.

Part 3: Did the ball strike another player above the waist but not in the head?

- **Yes:** Give a free kick to the team of the player struck and warn the player that kicked the ball that another offense by them will result in a Blue Card.
- **No:** Play on.

2.12 MERCY RULE

When a team gains a goal differential of +5 goals, the opposing team will be allowed to add one field player until the goal differential is +4 goals or less.

In coed leagues, the player taken off must still meet the two (2) female field player minimum.

2.13 GOALKEEPERS

- Goalkeepers must release a keeper restart outside of the arch for play to begin.
- Keepers have 5 seconds to put the ball in play outside of the arch on any stoppages.
- Keepers have a 5-second limit on ANY possession inside the arch, whether with the foot or hand. Failure to get the ball out of the box in 5 seconds will result in a free kick for the opponents at the top of the arch.

3. YOUTH LEAGUES RULES

3.1 THE PLAYERS

4 Years Old – 7 Years Old

- 4v4, no keepers
- Max roster: 8 players total, plus up to 2 coaches
- Small field

Girls 8–11 Years Old / Boys 8–11 Years Old

- 6v6 + keepers
- Max roster: 14 (combination of players and coaches)
  - 13 players + 1 coach
  - 12 players + 2 coaches
- Large field

Girls 12–17 Years Old / Boys 12–17 Years Old

- 5v5 + keepers
- Max roster: 14 (combination of players and coaches)
  - 13 players + 1 coach
  - 12 players + 2 coaches
- Large field

3.2 THE BALL

- 7 years old and below will use a size 3 ball.
- 8 through 11 years old will use a size 4 ball.
- 12 years old and above will use a size 5 ball.

3.3 THE COACHES

Only a **MAX** of **TWO** coaches per team will be allowed in the bench area. Coaches must have an **ACTIVE** membership with Bremerton Sports Center to be in the player bench area. In the event of a coach getting ejected, they can be replaced by another coach or parent with an **ACTIVE** membership with Bremerton Sports Center so that the game may resume. If there is no such person, the game will end regardless of the amount of time left, and the score will be recorded as is when it is called.

3.4 SAFETY

Headers are not permitted for ages 4–11 years old. A free kick will be called. In the event of a combined league, the oldest age group league rules will be in play.

3.5 MERCY RULE

- When a team gains a goal differential of +4 goals, the team that is down will be allowed to add one (1) field player until the goal differential is +3 or less. If the goal differential reaches +8 goals, the team that is ahead will be forced to remove one (1) field player until the goal differential reaches +7 or less.
- This applies to ALL youth leagues (Co-Ed High School is considered a youth league).

3.6 FIELD 3 RULES

6-Foot Line

- Players are not allowed to stand inside the space from the goal line to the 6' line acting as a "goalkeeper."
- If a player standing in this area touches the ball, a foul will be called, and the ball will be placed at the top of the arch.
- If a foul is called and the ball is brought back to the top of the arch, the defending team can have players stand on the 6' line, but they cannot stand inside the space between the 6' line and the goal line.
- Players are allowed to move through the area to defend the ball as long as they are continuously moving in and out of the space.

Kickoffs

- Kickoffs on Field 3 are **indirect**.